TRAINER ANSWER KEY

Final Challenge – End-to-End Investigation

Model guidance. The labels below describe potential issues for investigation, not proven misconduct.

Potential allegations / risk areas

1) Potential preferential treatment: E1 asks Nexa to match a budget and E2 indicates another bidder's lower quote was not considered. 2) Potential inappropriate sharing or procurement-process concern: E3 refers to a discussion over dinner and “take care of you.” 3) Potential procurement irregularity: two ■23.9 lakh invoices with the same laptop description. 4) Potential approval/process concern: the PO is approved by the same IT Admin Lead who appears in the emails.

Important caution

The case does not establish that the dinner involved a benefit, that the bidder was entitled to selection, that the two invoices were intentionally split, or that misconduct occurred. Those are questions for verification.

Suggested evidence to request

Full email chains and attachments; original bids and timestamps; procurement policy and approval thresholds; evaluation/scoring documents; purchase requisition; PO creation records; delivery/GRN records; invoice records; vendor due-diligence and conflict disclosures; relevant communications and interview accounts.

Timeline

05 Jan – E1 quote request. 08 Jan – E2 lower-quote question. 09 Jan – E3 email. 10 Jan – Invoice NX-501. 12 Jan – PO-7730. 15 Jan – Invoice NX-502.

Evidence matrix – model entries

Potential preferential treatment | E1, E2 | Budget-matching request and bidder question | Verify procurement process and bid evaluation | Open. Potential inappropriate communication | E3 | Dinner reference / “take care of you” wording | Obtain full context and interview | Needs verification. Potential invoice/order irregularity | NX-501, PO-7730, NX-502 | Same ■23.9 lakh amount and same description across two invoices | Check business purpose, dates, quantities and procurement records | Needs verification.

Management summary

A suitable summary should say that the preliminary review identified several indicators requiring further verification, while avoiding any statement that misconduct has been established. It should highlight evidence, gaps and next actions rather than speculate about intent.

Success criteria

A strong team output is traceable, neutral, concise and explicit about uncertainty. Copilot should accelerate organization and drafting—not replace investigator judgment.